



January 5, 2023

Office of Schools

Dear Parents/Guardians,

May the peace of Christ be with you!

“For a Child will be born to us, a Son will be given to us; and the government will rest on His shoulders; and His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Eternal Father, Prince of Peace” (Isaiah 9:5). I pray you had a blessed Christmas with your family. It was a time for prayer, rest, and rejuvenation for administrators, educators and students.

Catholic schools in the Diocese of Orlando have many great accomplishments. Our schools serve more than 14,000 birth-12th grade students with a 100% graduation rate and 97% college attendance earning more than \$41 million dollars in scholarships. Our Diocesan elementary schools perform 20% higher academically than the national average of private and public schools, while contributing more than 180,000 hours of charitable service annually. All of these accomplishments are possible because of God's grace and the hard work of principals and teachers.

You may be aware that over the past three years teacher salaries in the public school have increased with the assistance of your local, state, and federal tax dollars. We strive to keep our Catholic school salaries and benefits within a competitive range so that we can attract and retain talented educators. Catholic schools operate primarily on tuition and support from their local parishes. I am writing to inform you there likely will be a higher than usual tuition increase, so the Catholic school teacher salary scale can be modestly increased.

Currently, our teachers are paid less than their public school counterparts. Our teachers truly believe in the ministry of Catholic education, but still need a just wage to support their own families. The teacher salary scale has not been adjusted in several years while the cost of living has significantly increased in all areas. Therefore, we will be adjusting the teacher salary scale to demonstrate our commitment to our educators.

I believe you appreciate the hard work and sacrifices our teachers make in their ministry. This small increase does not reflect how valuable they are or the immeasurable contributions they make in the formation/education of your child. I thank our teachers for their hard work and sharing in the ministry of Catholic education. I also thank you for choosing Catholic education. It is not just an education of the mind, but of the entire child, most especially their soul. It is an investment, not just in this life but in the next life as well. May God bless you and your family as we begin this new calendar year.

Sincerely in Christ,

Henry Fortier
Secretary for Education/
Superintendent of Catholic Schools